Software Requirements Specification for Software Engineering: subtitle describing software

Team 24, Maca Boca
Javayria Mudassar
Yilin Jiang
Nour Fawaz
Catherine Yang

October 15, 2026

Contents

1 Introduction **1**
- 1.1 Purpose . . . 2
- 1.2 Scope . . . 2
- 1.3 Stakeholders . . . 2
- 1.4 Definitions and Acronyms . . . 2
- 1.5 Characteristics of Intended Reader . . . 4

2 System Overview **4**
- 2.1 Problem Statement . . . 4
- 2.2 Product Vision . . . 5
  - 2.2.1 Goals . . . 5
- 2.3 System Context . . . 5
- 2.4 User Characteristics . . . 6
- 2.5 System Constraints . . . 7

3 Stakeholder Requirements **7**

4 User Personas **7**
- 4.1 Overworked SLP in Favour of Automating the Speech Analysis Process . . . 7
- 4.2 Persona 2 . . . 8

5 Use Cases **8**
- 5.1 UC1: Assign Speaker Roles to the Auto-Generated Transcript . . . 8
- 5.2 UC2: Edit and Update Assessment Results . . . 9
- 5.3 UC3: View Assessment Results and Patient Progress . . . 10
- 5.4 Use Case Diagrams . . . 11

6 Functional Requirements **12**
- 6.1 Formal Specification . . . 15
  - 6.1.1 Workflow A: Direct Analysis . . . 15

7 Data Requirements **16**
- 7.1 Major Data Entities . . . 16
- 7.2 Data Dictionary . . . 16
- 7.3 Privacy and Data Retention . . . 16

8 Non-Functional Requirements **16**

9 AI and Machine Learning Requirements **18**
- 9.1 Model Inputs . . . 18
- 9.2 Model Outputs . . . 18
  - 9.2.1 Example Output . . . 19

9.3 Evaluation Metrics 19
9.4 Known Limitations 19

10 Requirements Traceability Matrices **19**

11 Rationale **20**

12 Likely Changes **20**

13 Unlikely Changes **20**

14 Appendices **21**
14.1 Appendix A: Additional Materials 21
14.2 Appendix B: Development Plan 22
14.3 Appendix C: Values of Auxiliary Constants 22
14.4 Appendix D: Generative AI Disclosure 22
14.4.1 AI Tools Used 22
14.4.2 How and Where Used 22
14.4.3 Verification of AI-Generated Content 23
14.5 Appendix E: Reflection 23
14.6 Nour 24

Revision History

Date	Version	Notes
14-10-2026	1.0	Added Sections
Date 2	1.1	Notes

[All capstone SRS documents should have a reflection appendix. —TPLT]

[This SRS template is based on the IEEE template, with input from co-pilot and S. Smith. It will get you started. You should not modify the section headings, without first discussing the change with the course instructor. Modification means you are not following the template, which loses some of the advantage of a template, especially standardization. —TPLT]

[Feel free to change the appearance of the report by modifying the LaTeX commands. —TPLT]

[This template document assumes that a single program is being documented. If you are documenting a family of models, you should start with a commonality analysis. —TPLT]

[The SRS is not generally written, or read, sequentially. The SRS is a reference document. It is generally read in an ad hoc order, as the need arises. —TPLT]

[Guiding principles for the SRS document:

- Do not repeat the same information at the same abstraction level. If information is repeated, the repetition should be at a different abstraction level.

—TPLT]

[The template description comments should be disabled before submitting this document for grading. —TPLT]

[You can borrow any wording from the text given in the template. It is part of the template, and not considered an instance of academic integrity. Of course, you need to cite the source of the template. —TPLT]

[When the documentation is done, it should be possible to trace back to the source of every piece of information. Some information will come from external sources, like terminology. —TPLT]

[An SRS document should have the following qualities: unambiguous, consistent, complete, validatable, abstract and traceable. —TPLT]

[The overall goal of the SRS is that someone can learn, understand and verify the captured domain knowledge. They should not have to trust the authors of the SRS on any statements. They should be able to independently verify/derive every statement made. —TPLT]

1 Introduction

[Explain what system is being specified. State purpose, users, and project goals. —TPLT]

[Introduce the name of your software as Software Engineering. Using Software Engineering as a command lets you change the name if necessary and have the change propagate to all documents. —TPLT]

[Include a reference to the template this work is based on. **?** justifies the SRS structure and **?** provides the broader life-cycle context that underlines modern requirements engineering practice. —TPLT]

1.1 Purpose

[State the purpose of the system. —TPLT]

[The purpose should be in the context of the project itself, not in the context of this course. Although the "purpose" of the document is to get a grade, you should not mention this. Instead, "fake it" as if this is a real project. —TPLT]

Software Engineering is intended to solve ... [What problem does your program solve? The description here should be in the problem space, not the solution space. —TPLT]

1.2 Scope

[Briefly describe:

- Problem being solved
- Intended users
- Major functionality
- Expected benefits
- Clarifying the scope often means saying what the software doesn't do

—TPLT]

[The scope section is relevant for understanding the boundaries of the system. It is also relevant for later determining typical values of inputs. The scope should make it clear what inputs are reasonable to expect. This is a distinction between scope and context (context is a later section). Scope affects the inputs while context affects how the software will be used. —TPLT]

TODO

1.3 Stakeholders

- Customer
- End Users
- Project Sponsor
- Development Team
- Administrators

1.4 Definitions and Acronyms

Term	Definition
MERLS	A web platform for Mandarin-English child language assessment. It brings together the assessment tools clinicians need, so they can complete their entire workflow in one place.
BeViz	Software that organizes and visualizes assessment results. It also detects potential interfering behaviors during an assessment (such as parent prompting) so clinicians can review them.
SAFA	Stands for "Speech Annotation For Application, Access, Accuracy." It automatically generates transcripts from recorded online speech assessments. Clinicians can then review, verify, and annotate the transcripts.
Clinician	A direct user of the system, typically an SLP (speech-language pathologist). Each clinician cares for one or more patients. Clinicians review assessment recordings, verify transcriptions and assessment results, and analyze overall performance.
Patient	An individual who uses MERLS to complete online speech assessments from home. Each patient is assigned to a clinician who oversees their care. Patients can also be referred to as clients.
Report	A detailed breakdown of a patient's results for a single speech assessment completed on the MERLS platform.
Speech Language Pathologist	They can also be referred to as a speech clinician.
Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act	An American federal law that permits the use of sensitive patient health information while protecting their privacy (Public Health Law Program, 2026).
Finite State Machine	A mathematical model that represents a sequential workflow as a set of states and transitions between them. A state may have one or more transitions leading to different states, which allows for multiple pathways through the workflow. At any given moment, the workflow is in exactly one state and may move to another state through a defined transition.
SLP	Speech-Language Pathologist
HCI	Human-Computer Interface

HCD	Human-Centered Design
FR	Functional Requirement
NFR	Non-Functional Requirement
HIPAA	Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act

Table 1: Definitions and Acronyms

1.5 Characteristics of Intended Reader

[This section summarizes the skills and knowledge of the readers of the SRS. It does NOT have the same purpose as the "User Characteristics" section (Section 2.4). The intended readers are the people that will read, review and maintain the SRS. They are the people that will conceivably design the software that is intended to meet the requirements. The user, on the other hand, is the person that uses the software that is built. They may never read this SRS document. Of course, the same person could be a "user" and an "intended reader." —TPLT]

[The intended reader characteristics should be written as unambiguously and as specifically as possible. Rather than say, the user should have an understanding of physics, say what kind of physics and at what level. For instance, is high school physics adequate, or should the reader have had a graduate course on advanced quantum mechanics? —TPLT]

2 System Overview

This section provides general information about the system. It identifies the problem, the vision, and the interfaces between the system and its environment. This section also describes user characteristics and lists the system constraints.

[The purpose of this section is to provide general information about the system so that the specific requirements in the later sections will be easier to understand. The general system description section is designed to be changeable independent of changes to the functional requirements documented in the specific system description. The general system description provides a context for a family of related models. The general description can stay the same, while specific details are changed between family members. —TPLT]

2.1 Problem Statement

[Current situation, problem, impact, desired improvement. You will likely borrow some text from your problem description document. —TPLT]

TODO

2.2 Product Vision

The purpose of this product is to give speech clinicians a single, centralized telehealth platform for reviewing, annotating, and analyzing speech assessments of bilingual children. By integrating SAFA's annotation tools into the platform and incorporating patient records in one place, the product aims to make the assessment analysis process faster, simpler, and easier to use.

2.2.1 Goals

1. **Integrate SAFA Into the MERLS platform:** Clinicians should be able to annotate assessments, meaning review and correct the written transcript of a recorded session, without leaving MERLS. SAFA is currently a standalone tool, and bringing it into the platform removes the need to switch between systems.

2. **Improve SAFA's Usability:** The annotation interface should be simple and guided enough that any speech clinician can use it with confidence, regardless of technical background.

3. **Speed Up Speech Annotation:** Annotating a bilingual speech assessment should take significantly less time than manual transcription. SAFA has already been shown to reduce annotation time by roughly one-third, and the goal is to preserve or improve on that once SAFA is part of MERLS.

4. **Provide a Clinician Record and Analysis Hub:** Clinicians should be able to find a patient's records and past assessments in a centralized hub. This will simplify clinicians' workflow, allowing them to quickly reference patient history without navigating multiple disconnected systems.

5. **Protect Patient Data:** MERLS handles sensitive health information online; hence the system must keep patient data private and secure. Only authorized clinicians can access a patient's records, recordings, and assessment results.

2.3 System Context

[Include users, external systems, APIs, databases, and third-party services. —TPLT]

[Your system context will include a figure that shows the abstract view of the software. In some cases the diagram will show other external entities, besides the user. For instance, when the software product is a library, the user will be another software program, not an actual end user. If there are system constraints that the software must work with external libraries, these libraries can also be shown on the System Context diagram. They should only be named with a specific library name if this is required by the system constraint. —TPLT]

[For each of the entities in the system context diagram its responsibilities should be listed. Whenever possible the system should check for data quality, but for some cases the user will need to assume that responsibility. The list of responsibilities should be about the



Figure 1: System Context

inputs and outputs only, and they should be abstract. Details should not be presented here. However, the information should not be so abstract as to just say "inputs" and "outputs". A summarizing phrase can be used to characterize the inputs. For instance, saying "material properties" provides some information, but it stays away from the detail of listing every required properties. —TPLT]

- User Responsibilities:
  - –
- Software Engineering Responsibilities:
  - Detect data type mismatch, such as a string of characters instead of a floating point number
  - –

[Identify in what context the software will typically be used. Is it for exploration? education? engineering work? scientific work?. Identify whether it will be used for mission-critical or safety-critical applications. —TPLT]

[This additional context information is needed to determine how much effort should be devoted to the rationale section. If the application is safety-critical, the bar is higher. This is currently less structured, but analogous to, the idea to the Automotive Safety Integrity Levels (ASILs) that McSCert uses in their automotive hazard analyses. —TPLT]

2.4 User Characteristics

[This section summarizes the knowledge/skills expected of the user. Measuring usability, which is often a required non-function requirement, requires knowledge of a typical user. As mentioned above, the user is a different role from the "intended reader," as given in Section 1.5. As in Section 1.5, the user characteristics should be specific an unambiguous. For instance, "The end user of Software Engineering should have an understanding of undergraduate Level 1 Calculus and Physics." —TPLT]

2.5 System Constraints

[System constraints differ from other type of requirements because they limit the developers' options in the system design and they identify how the eventual system must fit into the world. This is the only place in the SRS where design decisions can be specified. That is, the quality requirement for abstraction is relaxed here. However, system constraints should only be included if they are truly required. —TPLT]

[This is where you would mention platform constrains, and licensing restrictions. —TPLT]

3 Stakeholder Requirements

[Technology-independent requirements. These come from statements made by the stakeholders. You will find these through interviews and surveys. They are often expressed in natural language. They are not necessarily testable, but they should be verifiable. —TPLT]

[The stakeholder requirements are numbered so that you can have traceability to other parts of your document. —TPLT]

SR1 TODO

SR2 TODO

SR3 TODO

[You should give your SRs meaningful labels, so that you can refer to them in other parts of the SRS. The label names should be meaningful mnemonics, not numbers. —TPLT]

4 User Personas

4.1 Overworked SLP in Favour of Automating the Speech Analysis Process

- Name: James Caveat
- Description: James is a speech clinician at a large hospital, where he is responsible for more than 30 patients. His heavy workload means he must review many speech assessments during his working hours, leaving him little time to carefully absorb and transcribe what he is watching. As a result, it is difficult for him to give each assessment the attention it deserves.
- Goals: Speed up the analysis of speech assessments, receive assessment results quickly, obtain meaningful and clinically useful insights from each assessment, use a single system rather than learning and switching between multiple software tools, and have one simple place to organize his notes and patient information.

- Frustrations: James is discouraged by the amount of time it takes to annotate speech data, exhausted by having to watch and listen to numerous assessment recordings from start to finish, struggles to organize assessment data he collects, and has trouble analyzing large amounts of unstructured data.
- Technical Ability: James is comfortable with the basic tools he uses every day, but he is not technically fluent. He finds it difficult to move between different software systems and prefers to learn one tool well.

4.2 Persona 2

- Name:
- Description:
- Goals:
- Frustrations:
- Technical Ability:

5 Use Cases

[Use cases are a way to describe the interactions between users and the system. They are typically written in natural language and describe the steps that a user takes to achieve a specific goal. Use cases can be used to identify functional requirements and to create test cases. —TPLT] [Typically 8-15 substantial use cases. —TPLT]

5.1 UC1: Assign Speaker Roles to the Auto-Generated Transcript

Primary Actor

Clinician, System

Preconditions

- The clinician must be logged into their account in the system
- The clinician has selected a patient and opened one of that patient's video assessments

Main Success Scenario

1. The clinician selects and loads the video assessment they want to analyze
2. The system auto-generates transcriptions for the video assessment
3. The system displays the video playback along with the auto-generated transcriptions as chunks of text

4. The clinician selects a chunk
5. The system indicates which chunk is selected and presents that chunk's details for editing
6. The clinician selects the "Speaker" dropdown in the chunk's detail view
7. The system displays the following list of options for different possible speakers
    - System
    - Child
    - Parent
    - Experimenter
    - Multiple Speakers
    - Others
8. The clinician selects the correct role for the current speaker
9. The system labels the chunk with the selected role
10. The clinician repeats steps 4-9 for the remaining chunks

Alternative Flows

10a. The clinician may select any segment in any order, and the system indicates the newly selected segment. The clinician can then make any edits to the chunk of text using the given options.

Postconditions

- Each segment the clinician labeled has its assigned speaker role, and the roles are saved with the transcript.
- The labeled roles are still shown when the clinician reopens the assessment.

5.2 UC2: Edit and Update Assessment Results

Primary Actor

Clinician

Preconditions

- The clinician has an account and is logged in
- The clinician is analyzing one of their patient's speech assessments

Main Success Scenario

1. The clinician opens the assessment questions for the assessment
2. The system displays the assessment questions alongside the video of the point in the recording where each question was asked
3. The system indicates which questions have potential interference behavior
4. The clinician selects a flagged question
5. The clinician decides the flag is unjustified and removes it
6. The system saves the change and shows the question without the flag
7. The clinician moves on to another part of the analysis, such as annotating the transcript
8. The clinician notices interference behavior from a parent in a part of the recording they had previously cleared
9. The clinician returns to the affected question
10. The clinician flags the question again and adds a note describing the parent interference
11. The system saves the flag and notes and shows them with the question

Alternative Flows

3a. The system does not flag a question, but the clinician notices interference while working on another part of the analysis. The clinician returns to that question, flags it, and adds a note.

10a. The clinician changes their mind again and removes the flag or edits the note. The system saves the update and shows the latest version.

Postconditions

- The question shows the clinician's latest flag status and notes
- The latest flag status and notes are included in the generated assessment report.

5.3 UC3: View Assessment Results and Patient Progress

Primary Actor

Clinician

Preconditions

- The clinician has an account and is logged in
- The clinician has a patient with at least one completed assessment

Main Success Scenario

1. The clinician selects a patient from their list of clients
2. The system displays an overview of the patient, showing their performance trends across attempts and a list of their completed assessments
3. The clinician selects an assessment from the list
4. The system displays a summary of that assessment session, including:
    - The date of the assessment
    - The overall score
    - The recording of the session
    - The list of questions asked

Alternative Flows

3a. The clinician wants to see how the patient's performance has changed over time. Hence, the clinician reviews the trends shown in the patient overview, where the system presents the patient's results across multiple attempts.

Postconditions

- The clinician has seen a single assessment's results as a session summary along with the patient's progress across different attempts as a trend.

5.4 Use Case Diagrams

The following use case diagram shows the interactions between the clinician and the system for certain use cases described above.

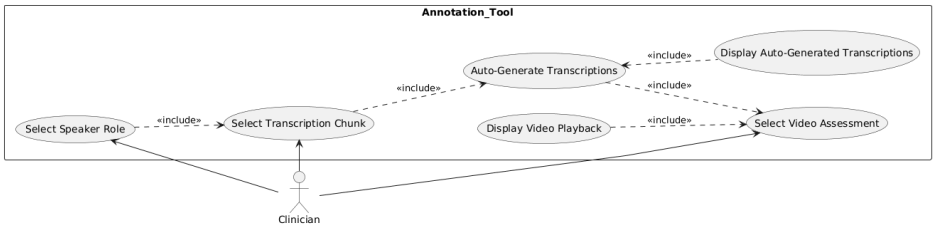


Figure 2: Use case diagram showing how a clinician assigns speaker roles to an assessment transcript using the annotation tool in MERLS. A detailed description is given in Use Case 1.

6 Functional Requirements

FR1 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR2 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR3 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR4 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR5 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR6 : The system shall allow clinicians to assign speaker roles and filter assessment transcripts by speaker.
Rationale: Automatically generated transcripts do not identify who is speaking. Clinicians need to distinguish the child's speech from that of adults, such as the parent or clinician, to analyze the child's language and identify interfering parent behavior.
Fit Criterion: The system must label every transcript segment from a speaker with the role assigned to that speaker once the clinician assigns it.

FR7 : The system shall generate detailed assessment reports from transcriptions, including any edits made by clinicians.
Rationale: Clinicians review and correct the automatically generated transcription, adjust flagged assessment questions, and add notes to individual questions. The report must reflect these changes so that it includes the clinician's judgment.
Fit Criterion: The system must include any changes made throughout the analysis process made by the clinician, otherwise it outputs the automatically generated content in the report.

FR8 : The system shall allow clinicians to edit and update assessment results at any time.
Rationale: Clinicians do not always analyze assessments sequentially. They may notice an error in a result or change their judgment after reviewing more of the recording, so they need to be able to go back and change results at any stage.
Fit Criterion: The system must display the updated result once the clinician submits a change.

FR9 : The system shall display a list of all assigned patients to the logged-in clinician.
Rationale: Clinicians care for multiple patients and need access to their information to properly care for each one. Additionally, they need a quick starting point for their work.
Fit Criterion: The system must display every patient assigned to the clinician once they log in. The system must display an empty list when the clinician has no assigned patients.

FR10 : The system shall allow clinicians to add new patients.
Rationale: Clinicians regularly take on new patients and need to create a profile for each one so that the patient's assessments and records can be managed in the system.
Fit Criterion: The system must add the new patient to the clinician's list of patients once the clinician creates the profile.

FR11 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR12 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR13 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR14 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR15 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR16 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR17 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR18 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR19 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR20 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR21 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR22 : The system shall display assessment results in a format suited to the assessment's purpose.
Rationale: Clinicians use progress-monitoring assessments to track change over time and diagnostic or screening assessments to evaluate a patient at a single point in time. Each purpose requires a different view of the results to be interpreted correctly.
Fit Criterion: The system must show progress-monitoring results as change over time and diagnostic or screening results as a single-session summary.

FR23 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

FR24 : The system shall ...
Rationale:
Fit Criterion:

6.1 Formal Specification

6.1.1 Workflow A: Direct Analysis

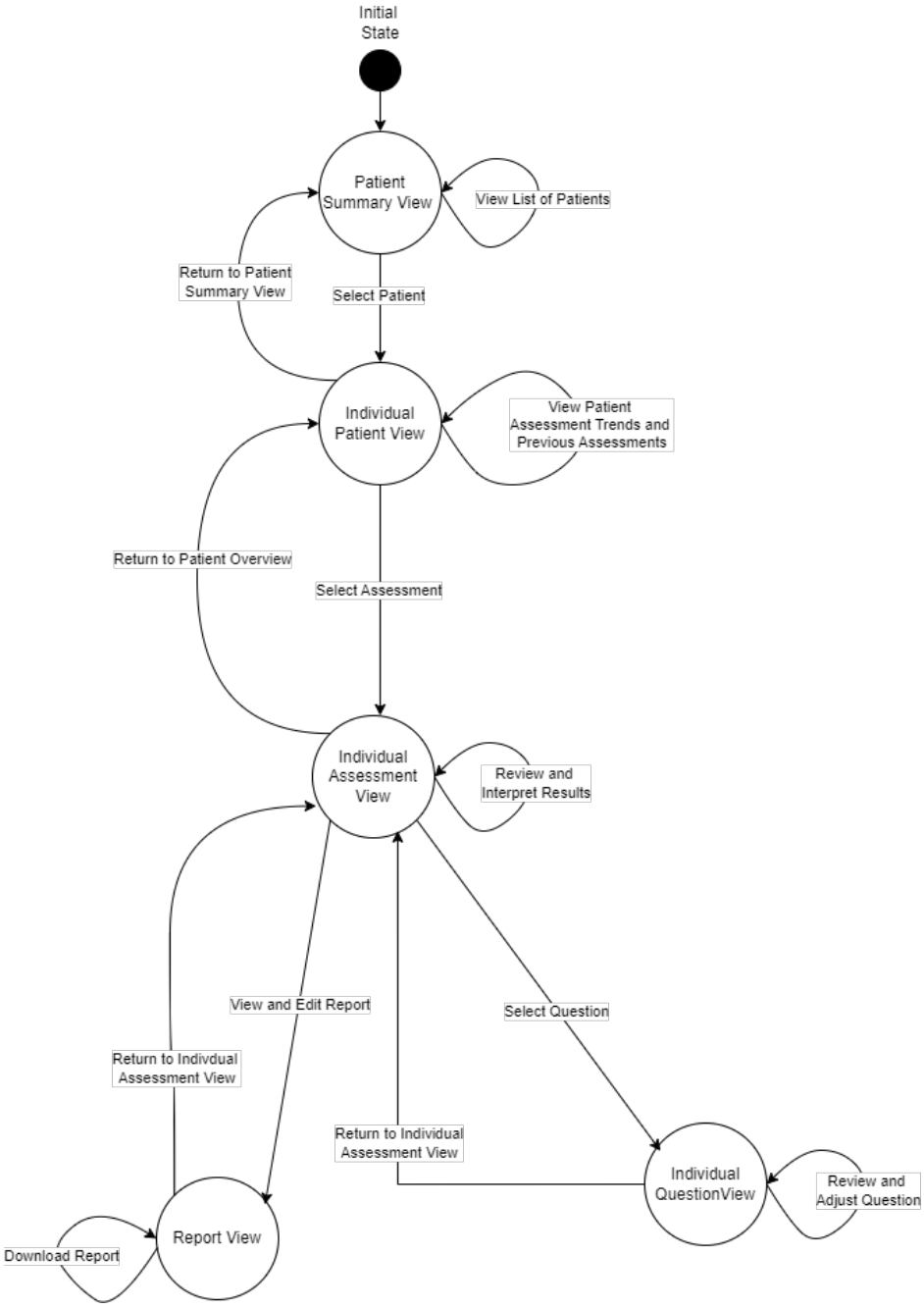


Figure 3: A finite state machine illustrating the direct analysis workflow (Workflow A) of a clinician when using the MERLS system.

7 Data Requirements

[The Data Requirements section describes what information the system must manage. It includes the major data entities, their attributes, and the relationships between them. It also includes a data dictionary that defines the meaning of each attribute. —TPLT]

7.1 Major Data Entities

[What information must exist for the system to accomplish its goals? —TPLT]
[For each entity, provide a short explanation. —TPLT]

- User
- Song
- Session
- Report

7.2 Data Dictionary

[For each entity, define all important attributes. —TPLT]

Attribute	Type	Description
user_id	UUID	Unique identifier
email	String	User email address

Table 2: Data Dictionary

7.3 Privacy and Data Retention

[Discuss storage, retention, deletion, privacy controls, consent, encryption, and compliance requirements. —TPLT]
TODO

8 Non-Functional Requirements

NFR1: The system shall be intuitive for users with limited technical fluency.
Rationale: Clinicians' technical fluency varies, and they have little time to learn new software. An intuitive system shortens the learning curve and avoids the need for formal training.
Fit Criterion: In usability testing, at least TASK_SUCCESS_RATE% of clinicians

with no prior training on the system must complete each core task (e.g., assign a speaker role, view assessment results, add a patient) without assistance within TASK_TIME minutes.

NFR2: The system shall present all functionality with clear and descriptive labels.
Rationale: Clinicians work under heavy workloads, and they may be unfamiliar with common software icons. Clear labeling lets them recognize what each function does without guessing.
Fit Criterion: In usability testing, at least TASK_SUCCESS_RATE% of clinicians must be able to locate and use each core function on their first attempt, relying only on the labels shown on screen and without assistance.

NFR3: The system shall allow clinicians to return to any previously visited stage of their workflow with minimal effort.
Rationale: Clinicians do not analyze assessments in a straight line. They may go back to review or correct earlier work, so moving between stages should not slow them down.
Fit Criterion: The clinician must be able to reach any previously visited stage of the workflow from the current page in at most MAX_NAV_STEPS navigation steps.

NFR4: The system shall immediately show clinicians the result of each change they submit.
Rationale: Clinicians edit sensitive patient information; therefore, they need quick confirmation that the system received their change and that it was applied correctly. Without immediate feedback, they cannot tell whether their action was registered, which causes uncertainty and repeated attempts.
Fit Criterion: The system must display the updated information to the clinician within SYSTEM_FEEDBACK_TIME seconds after the clinician submits a change.

NFR5: The system shall only allow a clinician to view the information of patients assigned to them.
Rationale: Patient assessments are sensitive health information. Access must be limited to the clinician responsible for the patient in order to protect patient privacy and meet data protection obligations.
Fit Criterion: The system must only list patients assigned to the logged-in clinician and must not allow a clinician to add or access a patient who is in another clinician's care.

NFR6: The system shall require users to re-enter their credentials after IDLE_TIMEOUT minutes of inactivity.
Rationale: Clinicians may leave their workstation unattended, and their accounts contain highly sensitive information. Automatic sign-out prevents unauthorized people from viewing it.
Fit Criterion: The system must end the user's session and require credentials before displaying any patient information once the user has been inactive for IDLE_TIMEOUT minutes.

NFR7: The system shall encrypt patient recordings and transcripts in transit and in storage.
Rationale: Assessment recordings and transcripts contain private patient information. The annotation service sends video assessments to a third-party transcription service, and the recordings are also kept in the system's storage. Hence, they must be protected in both places so that anyone who intercepts the data or gains access to the storage cannot read it.
Fit Criterion: The system must transmit all recordings and transcripts to third-party services using TRANSIT_ENCRYPTION_STANDARD and must store them using STORAGE_ENCRYPTION_STANDARD.

NFR8: The system shall regularly back up patient information and assessment recordings.
Rationale: Assessment data is difficult or impossible to recreate, so losing it would waste clinicians' work and could affect patient care.
Fit Criterion: The system must back up all patient information and assessment recordings at least every BACKUP_INTERVAL hours.

NFR9: The system shall only accept video assessments in which the speakers can be clearly seen and heard.
Rationale: The annotation tool and behavior detection depend on the recording's quality. Poor audio makes the auto-generated transcript less accurate, whereas poor video quality makes it difficult to detect faces and parent interference. Both instances can lead clinicians to wrong conclusions about a child's assessment.
Fit Criterion: The system must only accept submitted assessments where the recording at least meets the minimum video resolution, MIN_VIDEO_RESOLUTION, and the minimum audio level, MIN_AUDIO_LEVEL.

9 AI and Machine Learning Requirements

The system integrates a speech recognition model that was suggested and provided by the capstone team's supervisors. The model was not created by the capstone team.

The model used is OpenAI's Whisper-1, a general-purpose, multilingual automatic speech recognition and translation model. It is accessed through an API and takes audio or text as input (OpenAI, 2026).

9.1 Model Inputs

Individual segments of the assessment's audio file (.wav), each under 25 MB.

9.2 Model Outputs

A JSON object containing the start and end times of each segment, formatted as MM:SS (minutes:seconds), and a text field with the words spoken in the segment.

9.2.1 Example Output

```
[
  {
  "start": "00:00",
  "end": "00:05",
  "text": "Recognized words."
  }
]
```

9.3 Evaluation Metrics

The model is not currently being evaluated. The annotation tool does, however, let speech clinicians edit transcriptions in chunks, viewing the text next to the audio playback, so incorrect auto-generated transcriptions can be corrected.

The model could be evaluated in the future by comparing the original auto-generated transcriptions against the clinician-edited versions and calculating the word error rate.

9.4 Known Limitations

The model's website describes its performance as average, so the following failure modes are expected when it is used in MERLS (Laumann, 2022).

- **Incorrect transcription or translation:** since the model's overall performance is average, some transcribed or translated text can be wrong. If these errors go unnoticed, clinicians may draw incorrect conclusions about a child's speech abilities.
- **Incorrect transcription of difficult non-English words:** : the model is known to incorrectly transcribe difficult words in languages other than English. This is concerning for MERLS considering the system is used to assess bilingual children.
- **Uneven performance across different languages:** The model generally performs best on languages with a decent amount of training data, such as Spanish, German, Italian, and English. Transcript accuracy may vary by language, and languages with fewer resources may be transcribed less reliably.

Because of these expected failures, MERLS doesn't treat the model's output as final. Clinicians review the auto-generated transcript against the video playback and correct any errors before relying on it.

10 Requirements Traceability Matrices

Stakeholder Req	Use Case	Functional Req
SR1	UC??	FR1

Table 3: Traceability Between Stakeholder Requirements, Use Cases, and Functional Requirements

Functional Req	Nonfunctional Req
FR6	NFR2
FR7	NFR4
FR8	NFR3
FR9	NFR5
FR10	NFR4
FR22	NFR1

Table 4: Traceability Between Functional and Nonfunctional Requirements

11 Rationale

[Provide a rationale for the decisions made in the documentation. Rationale should be provided for scope decisions, functional requirements, nonfunctioanl requirements, data requirements, and AI requirements. You don't need a rationale for everything, ust the major decisions that are not obvious. You should have traceability to the entities in the document that you are referencing. —TPLT]

12 Likely Changes

LC1: [Give the likely changes, with traceability to the entity that is likely to change. —TPLT]

13 Unlikely Changes

LC2: [Give the unlikely changes. The design can assume that the changes listed will not occur. —TPLT]

14 Appendices

14.1 Appendix A: Additional Materials

This section presents key notes and quotes gathered during the requirements elicitation process for the project.

Several requirements were drawn from research papers describing the system and an experiment conducted by the project supervisor's team in the United States. Although the papers have not yet been released, they describe the entire system and report usability tests with 10 speech clinicians. The following highlights the preferences and feedback participants shared while testing the MERLS system and the SAFA annotation tool.

- Participant 2 expressed frustration with the amount of time it takes to transcribe assessments: "It would be perfect to have this feature, because doing the annotation part is very time consuming."
- Participant 3 disliked transcribing speech assessments and was enthusiastic about saving time: "when you say that it decreases transcription time, I got very excited about having less time in analyzing speech samples."
- Participant 3 also commented on how BeViz displays results: "I would definitely use the chart/graph/percentages." This is in regard BeViz in terms of displaying results.
- Participant 3 further said they preferred having analysis results summarized as scores, summaries, and patterns rather than as a spreadsheet: "quick and helpful, instead of everything in a spreadsheet."
- Participant 5 suggested what the report should contain: "The whole transcripts for all the [assessment] conversations would be useful to include in the report."
- Participant 5 also raised a concern about data privacy: "the challenge will be the HIPAA, and who has access to data, and how the data could be shared with the parents and the educator."
- Participant 7 appreciated the idea of auto-generated transcripts with human verification in the loop: "we can see a real-time transcription when we play the recording, so that we can do the analysis and give feedback."
- Several clinicians emphasized keeping a human in the loop during the assessment analysis portion of the workflow. For example, Participant 9 stated, "[the system should] allow the clinician to make the final judgment; this is a tool that does not replace our judgment."
- Several clinicians found the system straightforward. For example, participant 10 stated: "I think it's straightforward. You can see the video recording, originals, [and] place to write notes."

- Clinicians appreciated that the system covered the different aspects of the speech assessment workflow, particularly the ability to move from overall results to an individual question and review its prompt and response. Participant 10 stated, "you have the 'proof' there to support your clinical decision and your assessment."

- Participants preferred to have results presented in both English and Mandarin side by side, and to have assessments organized meaningfully by semantics, grammar, and phonology. Participant 10 elaborated: "if you have a feature comparing two languages, side by side in the same graph that would probably be helpful to decide differences vs. disorder."

14.2 Appendix B: Development Plan

[This section is optional. It is used to explain the plan for developing the software. In particular, this section gives a list of the order in which the requirements will be implemented. In the context of a course this is where you can indicate which requirements will be implemented as part of the course, and which will be "faked" as future work. This section can be organized as a prioritized list of requirements, or it could show the requirements that will be implemented for "phase 1", "phase 2", etc. —TPLT]

14.3 Appendix C: Values of Auxiliary Constants

[Show the values of the symbolic parameters introduced in the report. —TPLT]

[The definition of the requirements will likely call for SYMBOLIC_CONSTANTS. Their values are defined in this section for easy maintenance. —TPLT]

[The value of FRACTION, for the Maintainability NFR would be given here. —TPLT]

TODO

14.4 Appendix D: Generative AI Disclosure

14.4.1 AI Tools Used

- Claude Sonnet 5 (Medium)

- ChatGPT-5.6 Luna

14.4.2 How and Where Used

Both models were used in all the sections to do the following:

- Check that each written section answered every question asked and met the rubric requirements

- Improve the wording, clarity and the flow of written sections

- Debug possible LaTeX errors

The models were used to do the following in specific sections:

- Help brainstorm non-functional requirements in section 8, more specifically for security requirements
- Help verify correctness of the FSM diagrams to ensure workflows matched those specified in the research paper in the functional requirements section (Section 6).
- Brainstorm possible non-functional requirements in section 8

14.4.3 Verification of AI-Generated Content

To verify the output of the LLM, each team member went over their section and presented their work to the group, explaining what they had completed since the previous meeting. Each member was able to successfully explain their sections. Additionally, before any pull request was approved, a team member who had not written the section reviewed the work to ensure it was cohesive, accurate, and consistent with the rest of the document.

The factual content of the documents came from the research of the group members. The writer of each section researched, obtained, and documented all referenced sources. After the models suggested wording improvements, the writer re-read the section to confirm that it still conveyed the same point and that the research was not altered.

14.5 Appendix E: Reflection

The information in this section will be used to evaluate the team members on the graduate attribute of Lifelong Learning.

The purpose of reflection questions is to give you a chance to assess your own learning and that of your group as a whole, and to find ways to improve in the future. Reflection is an important part of the learning process. Reflection is also an essential component of a successful software development process.

Reflections are most interesting and useful when they're honest, even if the stories they tell are imperfect. You will be marked based on your depth of thought and analysis, and not based on the content of the reflections themselves. Thus, for full marks we encourage you to answer openly and honestly and to avoid simply writing "what you think the evaluator wants to hear."

Please answer the following questions. Some questions can be answered on the team level, but where appropriate, each team member should write their own response:

1. What went well while writing this deliverable?
2. What pain points did you experience during this deliverable, and how did you resolve them?

3. How many of your requirements were inspired by speaking to your client(s) or their proxies (e.g. your peers, stakeholders, potential users)?

4. Which of the courses you have taken, or are currently taking, will help your team to be successful with your capstone project.

5. What knowledge and skills will the team collectively need to acquire to successfully complete this capstone project? Examples of possible knowledge to acquire include domain specific knowledge from the domain of your application, or software engineering knowledge, mechatronics knowledge or computer science knowledge. Skills may be related to technology, or writing, or presentation, or team management, etc. You should look to identify at least one item for each team member.

6. For each of the knowledge areas and skills identified in the previous question, what are at least two approaches to acquiring the knowledge or mastering the skill? Of the identified approaches, which will each team member pursue, and why did they make this choice?

14.6 Nour

Question 1

Writing the functional requirements was more straightforward than we expected because we had enough resources to understand what our supervisors wanted from the project. They provided us with a couple of unreleased research papers that described the system architecture, clinician workflows, including a study they conducted on 10 clinicians to test the TeLaC (now MERLS) platform. With this information we were able to create a mental model of the MERLS, SAFA, and BeViz modules and what the purpose for each is. Moreover, our supervisors provided us with the GitHub repositories of the annotation tool SAFA and the MERLS system (which is the overall TeleHealth system). That let us write requirements that were realistic in how the system behaves and how it should behave once we integrate SAFA. Additionally, it made it easier to write use cases that reflected the different clinician workflows detailed in the research papers which are, direct analysis, annotation first analysis, and on-demand refinement. These three are the main important workflows and should be enabled by the system very seamlessly. Moreover, after speaking with our supervisors, we also learned which areas they are prioritizing and what the main features of the updated system should be. This helped us determine what requirements could change and what shouldn't change in the system.

Question 2

Creating user personas was my biggest challenge. The part of the system our group is working on is mainly for clinicians, so it was hard to identify different types of users, and we were worried the personas would end up looking nearly identical. Hence, we created

different "types" of clinicians who might use the platform and differentiated them by their work environment and capabilities, such as how heavy their workload is and how comfortable they are with technology. This gave us personas that reflect real differences in how the system might be used, which also helped us write non-functional requirements around usability.

Additionally, deciding how detailed each use case should be was also a bit difficult. I wasn't sure where in the workflow each one should start, and simulating the whole workflow from when the clinician enters the system felt like too much. It would have repeated the same steps, such as logging in and selecting a patient in every use case. Hence, I scoped each use case to a single clinician goal and used the preconditions to set the starting point. For example, the clinician is already logged in and has opened a patient's assessment. I also kept the steps focused on what the clinician does and how the system responds, and left out screen-level details, since the interface may change during the redesign.

Question 4

I took SFWRENG 4AL3, the applications of machine learning course. It helped me understand the kinds of models our supervisors may have used when building the SAFA tool, and I am comfortable with the machine learning terminology in our documents, such as word error rate and model inputs and outputs. Although we did not develop the model and it is not currently being evaluated, I understand how the audio files are segmented and sent to the model for transcription, and I can reason about its known limitations, such as weaker performance on non-English words. This is relevant because our users work with bilingual children. The course also taught me why disclosing AI use matters. We learned about the negative effects of large language models, including their large carbon footprint, and about the importance of being transparent about how they were used in our documents.

Question 5

Team management is extremely important for completing the project successfully. Our work is split across documents for different milestones, and each member's section has to fit with the others, so we need a clear picture of who is doing what and when it is due. Having good team management lets us stay on top of tasks, stay on the same page, and catch problems early on. Moreover, it means regular meetings where each member explains what they have completed since the last one, and discussion regarding the next project steps. This is important considering we are balancing the project along with our other courses. Furthermore, considering we are building on an existing system with already busy supervisors, we need to communicate regularly with them and record their feedback during meetings. Without this, it would be easy for sections to become inconsistent with each other and for team members to be lost or have a different understanding of the project vision and next steps.

Additionally, understanding of how SAFA uses AI to create transcriptions is also important. Integrating SAFA into the existing MERLS system is the main focus of our project, so we need to understand how the audio is sent to the model, what the model returns, and

where its transcriptions may be wrong, so we can design the system around this.

Question 6

For team management, one approach is keeping a planner or schedule that lists upcoming deadlines, notes, and future meetings. It keeps the team on track and helps us balance the project with other courses. Another is writing meeting minutes after each meeting. Minutes help the team manager see everyone's tasks and what still needs to be done, so that work is finished on time and with good quality. I chose to pursue team management because I have experience with group projects and prefer to know what is happening at all times during a project.

As for understanding how SAFA uses AI, one approach is reading the documentation for the speech recognition model and for SAFA, as well as going through SAFA's code. Another is asking our supervisors to walk the team through how transcriptions are generated and where they tend to fail. I will pursue this skill as well, mainly through the documentation and code review, because my machine learning course gave me a background in AI systems and their typical pitfalls, which should help me read the code and judge where the transcriptions may be unreliable.

References

Felix Laumann. Evaluating OpenAI's Whisper. Medium, November 2022. URL https://medium.com/neuralspace/evaluating-open-ais-whisper-40dfad2fe5d5. Accessed: Oct. 13, 2026.

OpenAI. Whisper. OpenAI Developers, 2026. URL https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/models/whisper-1. Accessed: Oct. 13, 2026.

Public Health Law Program. Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), 2026. URL https://www.cdc.gov/phlp/php/resources/health-insurance-portability-and-accountability-act-of-1996-hipaa.html. Accessed: Oct. 13, 2026.